Kitsune

"In the countryside where the hills meet the seabreeze and *the dunes give way to the Great Forest, there is a clearing. And in that clearing, there is a stone, flat as a table and smooth as the lake at dawn; where the moonlight hits just so and the sussuration of the leaves is the music of magic."*

The old woman sat in her chair in her house on the hill at the outskirts of town where the dogs do not go, telling a tale for a sad little girl. "And long ago, there sat a fox, old and dying, at the end of a lifespan ten times what it should be. It sat, and it sighed. And there, well... It cried.

"And that, little one," croaked Old Mari, cupping both hands around the small teacup "is when I was born." The teapot lifted slowly off the table, bouyed atop a mass of furry tails. It tipped, and was caught at the last second, filling the child's trembling cup carefully. "Now drink your tea," the old woman winked.

"Or else you'll grow tails like Mad Old Mari, who lives in the house on the hill."

Like many Fey-touched creatures, Kitsune drift through their long lives without much regard for normalcy. When imbued with the essence of the Feywild during a transformative event, a normal fox leaves behind its bestial existence and begins a far-stranger journey. The circumstance of their existence is rare, unusual, and totally irrelevant to the kitsune, as they are far more concerned with living than with their origins.

Mischievous Outcasts

Unconcerned with most worldly matters, Kitsune focus on those things which bring excitement and joy to their own lives. Most of them have already lived long, full lives as lowly foxes, so their humanoid existence is simply an unexpected bonus. This apparent indifference has led to a bad reputation in the eyes of the more serious races, and many communities root out any Kitsune infiltrators by force and by cautionary fairy-tale. Their ability to blend in to other cultures makes them stubborn guests, and many Kitsune undermine efforts through pranks of varying severities and by spreading their own wondrous tales amongst the children.

Kitsune are not immune to sadness and loss, however, and many of those cast out lead successful lives of true wickedness. Their role in life is as many others: to live; to suffer; to strive; to adventure; to learn; to teach; and to die.

Kitsune Traits

Ability Score Increase. Your Dexterity score increases by 2.

Age. Kitsune begin life as otherwise ordinary foxes that may live up to 100 years. Following some transformative event in that time, or upon reaching 100 years old, the ordinary fox permanently transforms into a vulpine-featured Kitsune and gains consciousness equivalent to other humanoids. Most Kitsune consider this event their "birthday," though they reach functional adulthood within 5 years. Single-tailed Kitsune may live 100 years from the date of their transformation.

Alignment. Kitsune are inherently mischievous, though most often this is due to their misunderstanding of generally accepted morality. Because of this, Kitsune are as likely to help another as they are to swindle them. Their vulpine ancestry makes most Kitsune tend towards chaotic alignments, and they are generally neutral in the conflict between good and evil.

Size. Kitsune heights range widely, from the tallest Halfling to the shortest Elf. Most stand approximately 5 feet tall and weigh 100 pounds. Your size is Medium.

Speed. Your base walking speed is 30 ft.

Languages. You can speak, read, and write Common and Sylvan. Sylvan is the language of the fey, and sounds much like the rustle of leaves in wind and the creak of branches.

Faerie Tails. Kitsune begin their humanoid lives with a single, furry, fox tail approximately 3 feet long. At 4th level, and every four levels afterwards, you grow an additional tail as you increase in age and worldly experience. Uplifttting or incredible events may also result in the growth of an additional tail, at the discretion of the DM, up to a maximum total of 9. Each tail you possess increases your lifespan by 11 years, to a maximum of an 199 year lifespan.

Tails which are cut off or otherwise removed do not grow back naturally, but may be restored by use of the 7th level Regenerate spell, or replaced by an uplifting event (at the discretion of the DM).

Fox Fire. You know the *dancing lights* cantrip and may produce an additional light for each tail you have. When you reach 3rd level, you may use this trait to cast the *faerie fire* spell, illuminating an area with your Fox Fire lights. The DC for this spell saving throw equals 8 + your Charisma modifier + your proficiency bonus.

When you reach 5th level, you may use this trait as a bonus action to deal 1d10 + (number of tails) points of lightning damage to the closest hostile creature within 30ft. of you. An enemy who succeeds on a Dexterity saving throw takes half damage. The DC for this saving throw equals 8 + your Charisma modifier + your proficiency bonus. This trait's damage increases by 1d10 when you reach 11th level (2d10 + number of tails) and 17th level (3d10 + number of tails).

You may use this trait once for each effect and regain the ability to do so when you finish a long rest.

Subrace. The nature of their uplifting event often determines the path Kitsune take in their humanoid lives. There are three primary paths a Kitsune may be born into, Tsuki (Lover), Inari (Shifter), and Yako (Trickster). Choose one of these subraces.

Tsuki (Lover)

Kitsune Tsuki are creatures of passion and beauty. Their fox-like features are subtle, and may consist only of slender faces, close-set eyes, and light dustings of fur in easily hidden places. They often slip unnoticed into human or halfling settlements, where they can live for years and even take up husbands and wives without ever being discovered. They retain their youth and beauty for their entire lifespan.

Ability Score Increase. Your Charisma score increases by 1.

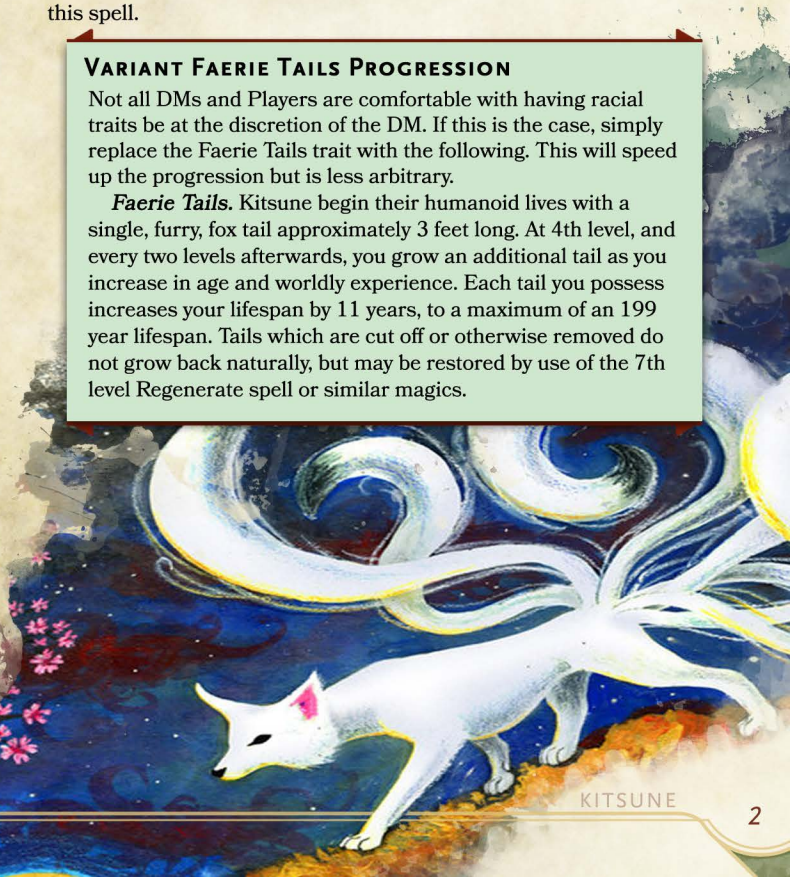
Clever Disguise. You have advantage on Charisma (Deception) checks made to pass as a Human or Halfling.

Fox's Charm. You can cast the *charm person* spell as a 1st-level spell once with this trait and regain the ability to do so when you finish a long rest. Charisma is your spellcasting ability for this spell.

Variant Faerie Tails Progression

Not all DMs and Players are comfortable with having racial traits be at the discretion of the DM. If this is the case, simply replace the Faerie Tails trait with the following. This will speed up the progression but is less arbitrary.

Faerie Tails. Kitsune begin their humanoid lives with a single, furry, fox tail approximately 3 feet long. At 4th level, and every two levels afterwards, you grow an additional tail as you increase in age and worldly experience. Each tail you possess increases your lifespan by 11 years, to a maximum of an 199 year lifespan. Tails which are cut off or otherwise removed do not grow back naturally, but may be restored by use of the 7th level Regenerate spell or similar magics.



Inari (Shifter)

Foxes who reach age 100 without undergoing a transformative event become Kitsune Inari: forever estranged from civilization, but overcome with curiosity. They transform into wise, bipedal foxes, with thick red fur, thin snouts, and tufted ears, and gain the ability to shapeshift into a humanoid form for long periods of time. Their appearance when in humanoid form is similar to that of a Kitsune Tsuki, but they lack the social grace of the Tsuki, and are more easily discovered when they attempt to infiltrate a settlement. Still, their curiosity draws them to the hustle and bustle of civilization, and they eagerly observe and emulate the tenets of civilized life.

Ability Score Increase. Your Wisdom increases by 1.

Bite attack. Your jaws retain their needle-like fox teeth. You gain a 1d4 piercing damage bite, with which you are proficient. This damage increases by 1 for each of your tails.

Human form. You can cast the *disguise self* spell a number of times per day equal to the number of tails you have. Your form while under the effects of this spell is always the same, and you must choose the physical features that represent your Human form at 1st level. Wisdom is your spellcasting ability for this spell.

Yako (Trickster)

Kitsune Yako are far more likely to embrace their mischievous nature. Short, reddish fur covers their bodies, their facial features are distinctly vulpine, and some even retain the backfacing knee of their bestial origins. Their difficulty passing as human necessitates an especially quick wit and cleverness, and most Kitsune Yako thrive in unexpected circumstances. Their possessive nature may extend to other people's belongings, and many Yako Kitsune follow the path of a thief or hoarder. Elderly Kitsune Yako may appear hunched and feeble, but it is only a ruse to fool an easy mark, as the ravages of time have little effect on a Yako Kitsune's wit or agility.

Ability Score Increase. Your Intelligence score increases by 1.

Sticky Fingers. You have advantage on Dexterity (Sleight of Hand) checks made to pick pockets without being noticed.

Vulpine Luck. When you roll a 1 on an attack roll, ability check, or saving throw, you can reroll the die and must use the new roll. You can use this feature once per tail you possess, and regain the ability to do so when you finish a long rest.

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